

Updated July 17, 2026

Christina Laternser, Ph.D.

Biostatistician | Economist | Health-Systems Researcher

CONTACT INFORMATION

Business Address: Ann & Robert H. Lurie Children's Hospital of Chicago
225 E. Chicago Avenue, Chicago, IL 60611
Email: claternser@luriechildrens.org
Website: christinalaternser.github.io/christina-latarnser/
Profiles: [Google Scholar](#) | [ORCID](#)

EDUCATION

2016 - 2022 **Ph.D., Economics** (University of Chicago Scholar)
University of Illinois at Chicago, Chicago, IL
2016 - 2018 **M.A., Economics**
University of Illinois at Chicago, Chicago, IL
2012 - 2014 **M.S., Economics and Public Analysis**
DePaul University, Chicago, IL
2010 - 2011 **M.S., Mathematics**
Fairfield University, Fairfield, CT
2006 - 2010 **B.S., Mathematics; Minors in Politics and Philosophy**
Fairfield University, Fairfield, CT

ACADEMIC & PROFESSIONAL POSITIONS

2021 - Present **Biostatistician**
Ann & Robert H. Lurie Children's Hospital of Chicago, Department of Pediatrics, Chicago, IL
Conduct independent health-systems and pharmaceutical-policy research and collaborate on pediatric cardiovascular outcomes research; lead study design, statistical and econometric analysis, interpretation, and manuscript development.
2018 - 2022 **Research Assistant**
University of Illinois at Chicago, Chicago, IL
2016 - 2022 **Teaching Assistant, Economics**
University of Illinois at Chicago, Chicago, IL
2011 - 2023 **Adjunct Faculty, Mathematics and Economics**
DePaul University and Columbia College Chicago, Chicago, IL
2013 - 2014 **International Actuarial Analyst**
Towers Watson, Chicago, IL

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Pharmaceutical industrial organization and regulation; maternal health access and obstetric-system structure; perinatal regionalization; congenital and pediatric cardiovascular outcomes; applied econometrics, biostatistics, and geospatial methods.

HONORS & AWARDS

2025 **Second Place, Young Investigator Award, American Academy of Pediatrics National Conference and Exhibition**
Awarded for "Are discharge barriers responsible for insurance-based differences in length of stay after congenital heart surgery?"
2020 **Elizabeth Bass Award**
2010 **Highest score on the university-wide Mathematics Comprehensive Examination**
Fairfield University
2006 - 2010 **Graduated with Distinction, Fairfield University Honors Program**

PROFESSIONAL & HONOR SOCIETY MEMBERSHIPS

Pi Mu Epsilon (Mathematics) | Pi Sigma Alpha (Political Science) | Phi Sigma Tau (Philosophy) | Phi Kappa Phi (Academic Achievement) | Beta Gamma Sigma (Business)

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Journal Peer Review

Reviewer, Journal of Visualized Experiments (JoVE), 2026

Invited Talks

Invited Speaker, "Regulatory Architecture and the Timing of Orange Book Patent Listings" (conference program title: "Regulatory Design and Strategic Patenting Under the Hatch-Waxman Act"), 10th Annual Boston University TPRI IP Day, Boston, MA, July 20, 2026.

TEACHING & MENTORING

2011 - 2023	Adjunct Faculty - Mathematics and Economics DePaul University and Columbia College Chicago Prepared and delivered courses in quantitative methods and economic theory; designed course materials and supported students across varied levels of preparation.
2016 - 2022	Teaching Assistant - Economics University of Illinois at Chicago Developed course materials and virtual forums and managed course sections of up to 180 students.

PUBLICATIONS & SCHOLARLY WORKS

*Author name in bold denotes Christina Laternser. Publications are listed in reverse chronological order. * First author; † last author.*

A. Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles, including in press (N=28; first author=4; last author=4)

- Webster G, Gill N, Carberry T, Chandler SF, Cherny S, Lockhart EN, et al., **Laternser C†**. Beta-blockers and exercise performance in children with long QT syndrome. *JACC: Clinical Electrophysiology*. In press. 2026.
- Watanabe K, Magnetta DA, **Laternser C**, Birjiniuk A, Robinson JD, et al. Abnormal cardiac magnetic resonance imaging mapping parameters in pediatric heart transplant patients with elevated donor-derived cell-free DNA. *Pediatric Cardiology*. 2026.
- Cox K, Husain N, Ansah D, Knight T, Channing A, Cuneo B, et al., **Laternser C**, et al. Prenatal predictors of fetal and neonatal death in truncus arteriosus: a Fetal Heart Society Research Collaborative study. *Journal of the American Heart Association* 15(13):e043555. 2026.
- Woo JL, Grobman WA, Mongé MC, Anderson BR, Batton B, Yee LM, **Laternser C†**. Time-to-transfer and hospitalization duration for severe congenital heart defects: implications for perinatal regionalization. *The Journal of Pediatrics* 115220. 2026.
- Boyd RM, **Laternser C**, Migally K, Patel SG, Dababneh R, Carr MR, et al. Fontan-related lymphatic complications: incidence, risk factors, and impact on extracardiac outcomes and morbidity. *Journal of the American Heart Association* 15(12):e043310. 2026.
- Zdanowicz Z, **Laternser C**, Crilly CJ, Kan K, Lay AS, Woo JL. Discharge barriers and length of stay following congenital heart surgery: a mixed-methods approach. *Journal of the American Heart Association* 15(11):e047918. 2026.
- O'Halloran CP, Alsaied T, Wang AP, Ward K, **Laternser C**, Files MD, et al. Fontan conduit cross-sectional area and relationship to exercise performance. *Journal of Cardiovascular Magnetic Resonance* 102729. 2026.
- Lawson AA, Lottes RG, Magnetta D, Watanabe K, Rigsby CK, Markl M, **Laternser C**, Husain N, Robinson JD. Serial CMR findings in pediatric heart transplant recipients. *Journal of Cardiovascular Magnetic Resonance* 28. 2026.
- Patel S, McBrien A, Michelfelder E, Kavanaugh-McHugh A, Samples S, **Laternser C**, et al. Current trends in fetal cardiology: results from an international benchmarking survey of fetal cardiac programs through the Fetal Heart Society research collaborative. *Pediatric Cardiology* 47(3):1218-1228. 2026.
- Laternser C***. Feasibility Versus Vulnerability in the Geographic Distribution of Obstetric Services. *Milbank Quarterly*. In press. 2026. doi:10.1111/1468-0009.70114.
- Laternser C***, Grobman WA, Albaro C, Anderson BR, Batton B, Yee LM, Woo JL. Prenatal care and perinatal regionalization for congenital heart defects. *JAMA Network Open* 8(11):e2542135. 2025.
- Laternser C***, Anderson BR, Yee LM, Grobman WA, Batton B, Knepp MD, et al. Individual risk versus population incidence: a case example with congenital heart defects. *Academic Pediatrics* 103187. 2025.
- Aboyewa O, Popescu A, Lee S, Camarda J, Hong KP, Shah D, **Laternser C**, et al. Evaluation of wideband pulse sequences for suppressing image artifacts in children with cardiac implantable electronic devices. *Radiology: Cardiothoracic Imaging* 7(6):e250310. 2025.
- Woo JL, Gotteiner N, Anderson BR, Yee LM, Grobman WA, Davis MM, **Laternser C†**. Prenatal diagnosis mediates the relationship between disease complexity and intervention timing for congenital heart defects. *Pregnancy* 1(3):e70011. 2025.
- Woo JL, Gandhi R, **Laternser C**, Iyengar T, Yee LM, Grobman WA, et al. Second-trimester ultrasound receipt mediates the relationship between public insurance and prenatal diagnosis of a congenital heart defect. *Prenatal Diagnosis* 45(7):886-895. 2025.
- Haregu A, Watanabe K, Hauck A, **Laternser C**, Husain N. Left atrial function correlates with fibrosis in pediatric heart transplant recipients. *Echocardiography* 42(7):e70234. 2025.
- Lawson AA, Watanabe K, Griffin L, **Laternser C**, Markl M, Rigsby CK, Robinson JD, Husain N. Multiparametric cardiovascular magnetic resonance is associated with outcomes in pediatric heart transplant recipients. *Journal of Cardiovascular Magnetic Resonance* 27(1):101138. 2025.
- Lawson AA, Tannous P, **Laternser C**, Migally K. The estimated Fick method systematically over-estimates cardiac index compared to thermodilution in children. *Pediatric Cardiology* 46(3):713-718. 2025.
- O'Halloran CP, Hauck A, Fox J, **Laternser C**, Hoyt E, Nugent AW, et al. Side cell dilation of jailed pulmonary veins after stenting improves vessel preservation in pediatric pulmonary vein stenosis. *Catheterization and Cardiovascular Interventions* 106(3):1732-1739. 2025.
- Woo JL, Gandhi R, Iyengar T, Yee L, Davis M, Grobman W, Johnson J, Patel A, **Laternser C†**. Disparities in prenatal diagnosis of congenital heart defects: the interplay of insurance and urbanicity. *Journal of the American Heart Association* 13(16):e035440. 2024.
- Birjiniuk A, Weisman AG, **Laternser C**, Camarda J, Brickman WJ, Habiby R, Patel SR. Cardiovascular manifestations of Turner syndrome: phenotypic differences between karyotype subtypes. *Pediatric Cardiology* 45(7):1407-1414. 2024.
- Aboyewa OB, **Laternser C**, Popescu A, Murphy N, Shah D, Mongé MC, Rigsby CK, Golestanirad L, Webster RG, Kim D. Cumulative radiation dose from medical imaging in pediatric congenital heart disease patients with epicardial cardiac implantable electronic devices. *European Heart Journal - Imaging Methods and Practice* 2(1):qyae060. 2024.
- Wang AP, Husain N, Penk J, **Laternser C**, Magnetta D, Watanabe K, Hauck A. Prognostic value of RV function analysis during the interstage period in patients with hypoplastic left heart syndrome. *Pediatric Cardiology* 45(5):1120-1128. 2024.
- Shah A, **Laternser C**, Tatachar P, Duong P. The COVID-19 pandemic and its effects on mental health: a before, during, and after comparison using the U.S. Census Bureau's Household Pulse Survey. *International Journal of Environmental Research and Public Health* 21(10):1306. 2024.
- Woo JL, **Laternser C**, Anderson BR, Grobman WA, Mongé MC, Davis MM. Association between prenatal diagnosis and age at surgery for noncritical and critical congenital heart defects. *Circulation: Cardiovascular Quality and Outcomes* 16(9):e009638. 2023.

- Jiang F, Henry KR, Bhusal B, Sanpitak P, Webster G, Popescu A, **Laternser C**, Kim D, Golestanirad L. Age matters: a comparative study of RF heating of epicardial and endocardial electronic devices in pediatric and adult phantoms during cardiothoracic MRI. *Diagnostics* 13(17):2847. 2023.
- Lawson AA, Watanabe K, Griffin L, **Laternser C**, Markl M, Rigsby CK, Sojka M, Robinson JD, Husain N. Late-gadolinium enhancement is common in older pediatric heart transplant recipients and is associated with lower ejection fraction. *Journal of Cardiovascular Magnetic Resonance* 25(1):61. 2023.
- Lockhart EN, Carr M, Allen K, Samis J, Torchen L, **Laternser C**, Bian Y, Patel S. Prevalence of abnormal hemoglobin A1c values in single ventricle patients following Fontan palliation. *Pediatric Cardiology* 44(5):1083-1091. 2023.

B. Manuscripts Under Review

- Laternser C***. Are discharge barriers responsible for insurance-based differences in length of stay after congenital heart surgery? Under review, *Cardiology in the Young*.
- Laternser C***. Transition dynamics of county obstetric service absence: population exposure and status changes in the United States, 2015-2023. Revise and resubmit, *Health Services Research*.
- Laternser C***. Three-regime structure of obstetric service environments. Under review, *Maternal and Child Health Journal*.
- Laternser C***. Maternity care deserts and the timing of prenatal care initiation. Under review, *American Journal of Public Health*.
- Laternser C***. Structural feasibility of inpatient obstetric service availability in Illinois: a cross-sectional county-level study. Under review, *Journal of Public Health Management and Practice*.
- Laternser C***. County prevalence versus population exposure in measuring areas without maternity services: evidence from Illinois, 2015-2023. Under review, *Women's Health Issues*.

C. Working Papers and Manuscripts in Preparation

Industrial Organization and Pharmaceutical Policy

- Laternser C***. Regulatory architecture and the timing of Orange Book patent listings. SSRN 6036037 (circulated under the earlier title "Regulatory Design and Strategic Patenting Under the Hatch-Waxman Act"). Working paper; invited presentation at Boston University TPRI IP Day, July 2026.
- Laternser C***. Regulatory architecture and the timing of generic competition. SSRN 6764179. Working paper.
- Laternser C***. Structural feasibility and the architecture of pharmaceutical protection regimes. SSRN 6809286. Working paper.
- Laternser C***. The geometry of regulatory protection regimes in pharmaceutical markets. SSRN 6618615. Working paper.

Health Services Research

- Laternser C***. Measurement-behavior alignment in obstetric access. Manuscript in preparation.
- Laternser C***. Accessibility is not redundancy. Manuscript in preparation.
- Laternser C***. Structural constraints across the perinatal pathway. Manuscript in preparation.
- Laternser C***. Measuring structural access to obstetric services. Manuscript in preparation.

D. Theses and Dissertation

- Laternser C***. Volumes in hyperbolic space. Master's thesis, Mathematics. arXiv:1111.2498. 2011.
- Laternser C***. A study of innovation v. competition: how did regulation affect firm behavior via the Hatch-Waxman Act? Doctoral dissertation, Economics, University of Illinois at Chicago. 2022. doi:10.25417/uic.20254128.v1.

E. Policy Reports

- Chaloupka F, Drope J, Siu E, Vulovic V, Mirza M, Rodriguez-Iglesias G, Ngo A, **Laternser C**, Lee H, Dorokhina M, Smith M. Tobacconomics cigarette tax scorecard, 2nd edition: scoring component policy note - affordability change. Chicago, IL: Health Policy Center, Institute for Health Research and Policy, University of Illinois Chicago. 2021.

F. Conference Abstracts and Proceedings

- Laternser C***, Zdanowicz Z, Lay A, Woo J. Are discharge barriers responsible for insurance-based differences in length of stay after congenital heart surgery? *Circulation* 152(Suppl_3):A4370023. 2025. Second Place Young Investigator Award, American Academy of Pediatrics.
- Laternser C***, Grobman W, Albaro C, Anderson B, Batton B, Yee L, Woo J. Prenatal care and perinatal regionalization of congenital heart defect care. *Circulation* 152(Suppl_3):A4370165. 2025.
- Karahalios DS, **Laternser C**, Thrush P, Garg A, Morrison A, Mongé M, et al. Effect of pediatric heart transplant waitlist inactivation on waitlist and post-transplant outcomes. *Journal of Heart and Lung Transplantation* 44(4):S345. 2025.
- Lockhart EN, Woo J, Cosantino A, **Laternser C**, Joong A. Failed dental evaluations in pediatric heart transplant recipients. *Journal of the American College of Cardiology* 85(12_Supplement):756. 2025.
- Woo J, Gotteiner N, Anderson B, Yee L, Grobman W, Davis M, **Laternser C**. Is prenatal diagnosis responsible for differences in timing to postnatal intervention for critical congenital heart defects? *Circulation* 150(Suppl_1):A4139179. 2024.
- Woo J, Gandhi R, **Laternser C**, Iyengar T, Yee L, Grobman W, Davis M, et al. Performance of second-trimester ultrasound mediates the relationship between public insurance and prenatal diagnosis of a congenital heart defect. *AcademyHealth Annual Research Meeting*. 2024.
- Boyd R, **Laternser C**, Patel S, Migally K, Patel S. Fontan-related lymphatic complications are associated with extracardiac outcomes and morbidity. *Circulation* 150(Suppl_1):A4125294. 2024.
- Tumuluru P, Lockhart E, Carr M, Kriegermeier A, **Laternser C**, Patel S. Abnormal liver stiffness as a risk factor for elevated hemoglobin A1c in patients with Fontan physiology. *Circulation* 150(Suppl_1):A4146827. 2024.
- Lawson A, Lee S, Popescu A, Tannous P, **Laternser C**, Markl M, Rigsby C, et al. Myocardial perfusion reserve index in pediatric heart transplant recipients. *Circulation* 150(Suppl_1):A4142989. 2024.
- Zellmer B, Polsen C, Husain N, **Laternser C**, Jone PN. Comparison of strain injury and recovery between COVID-19 vaccine related myocarditis versus multisystem inflammatory syndrome in children (MIS-C). *Journal of the American Society of Echocardiography* 37(7):38. 2024.
- Watanabe K, Haregu A, Arva N, **Laternser C**, Husain N. Fibrosis and microvessel disease are common findings on endomyocardial biopsy in pediatric heart transplant recipients. *Journal of Heart and Lung Transplantation* 43(4):S466. 2024.

- Watanabe K, Birjiniuk A, Crawford RL, Robinson JR, Magnetta D, Rigsby C, **Laternser C**, Husain N. Relations between cardiac magnetic resonance imaging and cell-free DNA in pediatric heart transplant - a pilot study for the future of heart transplant surveillance. *Journal of Heart and Lung Transplantation* 42(4):S482. 2023.
- Kalb EM, **Laternser C**, Mongé M, Thrush P. Sensitized pediatric heart transplant recipients in a ten-year single-center study. *Journal of Heart and Lung Transplantation* 42(4):S155. 2023.
- Haregu A, Watanabe K, Ramlogan S, **Laternser C**, et al. Novel parameters of left atrial function assessment in pediatric heart transplant recipients. *Journal of the American Society of Echocardiography* 36(7):e18. 2023.
- Patel SR, Dababneh R, Bian Y, **Laternser C**, Patel A, Patel SG. Inferior vena cava diameter by transthoracic echocardiography predicts catheter-based hemodynamics in single ventricle congenital heart defects patients with Fontan palliation. *Journal of the American Society of Echocardiography* 36(7):e25-e26. 2023.
- Jacobson E, Carr M, Allen KY, Samis J, Torchen L, **Laternser C**, Bian Y, et al. Prevalence of abnormal hemoglobin A1c values in single ventricle patients following Fontan palliation. *Journal of the American College of Cardiology* 81(8_Supplement):1571. 2023.
- Lawson AA, Tannous P, **Laternser C**, Migally K. The Fick method with Lafarge estimates of oxygen consumption systematically over-estimates cardiac index when compared to thermodilution in children. *Circulation* 146(Suppl_1):A13590. 2022.
- Webster G, Coons DE, Carberry T, Chandler SF, Cherny S, Jacobson EN, **Laternser C**, et al. Dose response and long QT genotype during exercise stress testing in children. *Circulation* 146(Suppl_1):A11237. 2022.
- Lawson AA, Watanabe K, Griffin L, **Laternser C**, Markl M, Rigsby CK, et al. Prevalence of late gadolinium enhancement following pediatric heart transplantation increases with time since transplantation. *Circulation* 146(Suppl_1):A13193. 2022.